

ting. As an example, the Realme GT 6T with the same chipset scores higher in nearly every CPU performance benchmark. The CPU Throttling Test shows that the phone throttles to 77 percent of its peak performance after 15 minutes of running the test. In contrast, the Realme GT 6T throttled to 80 percent, but the disparity between the benchmark scores is higher than this one.

In GPU benchmarks, the OnePlus Nord 4 does a good job, often surpassing the Realme GT 6T scores, but the POCO F6 still remains firmly in first place. The overall benchmark performance of the OnePlus Nord 4 lags behind the POCO F6 and Realme GT 6T but it manages to beat the Motorola Edge 50 Pro with ease.

Gaming is a smooth affair too. OnePlus has fitted the device with a large vapour chamber for cooling, which ensures the frame rates in games such as BGMI and Call of Duty: Mobile remain stable. I didn't feel the device heat too much even when I pushed it to the highest graphics allowed on these games.

As for the UI, the OnePlus Nord 4 comes with ColorOS OxygenOS 14.1 which sits on top of Android 14. The phone offers OnePlus' longest-ever software support package – four years of OS updates and six years of security updates, which is a rarity at this price. It has also bagged the TÜV SÜD Fluency 72 Month A rating, which certifies that the phone won't slow down or stutter for 72 months. The OS does have some bloatware in the form of a few games, some third-party apps, and OnePlus apps, but it is on the lower side, which is much appreciated.

AI FEATURES AND DIGIT AI-Q SCORE

The OnePlus Nord 4 has an array of AI features; however, some were not available for me to test as I used the device before launch. OnePlus' Trinity Engine leverages AI to ensure smooth operations on the phone. There are also some useful AI features such as AI Audio Summary, AI Note Summary, AI Text Translate, AI Link-boost (for boosting the mobile network), AI Magic Eraser, Auto Pixellate, and more. As I mentioned, not all of these were avail-

able for me to test, but the ones I did test such as AI Magic Eraser, Auto Pixellate, and others worked fine. I also tested the phone's AI hardware capabilities by running a slew of benchmarks, and the phone got a total Digit AI-Q score of 33/100 which beats its competitors such as the Realme GT 6T and Motorola Edge 50 Pro.

CAMERA

The OnePlus Nord 4 boasts a 50 MP Sony LYT-600 primary camera with OIS support and an f/1.8 aperture. There's a secondary 8 MP ultrawide shooter and a 16 MP selfie camera. While the setup stands up to the one on the Realme GT 6T, the Motorola Edge 50 Pro's triple camera setup has an added telephoto lens which ups its appeal for photography enthusiasts.

Now, due to the heavy rains in Mumbai during my testing period, I couldn't click as many camera samples on this phone as I usually do, but I will update this review when I have a few more to show off. Initial impressions of the primary camera are pretty positive though. The primary camera's dynamic range is strong with good detail retention and decent colour accuracy. Low-light photos are also packed with detail thanks to OnePlus' Night Mode algorithm.

However, the 8 MP ultrawide camera photos lack detail in the shadows and the corners of these photos are a bit noisy. Portrait photos come out looking decent, but skin tones and edge detection could be improved further.

The phone supports 4K video recording at up to 60 fps on the rear camera. Videos come out looking good but stabilization could be better when shooting active scenes. The front camera only supports 1080p video at 30 fps, which is sub-standard as both the Realme GT 6T and Motorola Edge 50 Pro support 4K at 30 fps video from the selfie camera.

BATTERY LIFE

Sporting a monstrous 5,500 mAh battery, the OnePlus Nord 4's endurance is very impressive. The phone easily gives me a screen-on time of 11-12 hours on days with light usage, and 8-9 hours on days with lots of gaming mixed in. The phone is tested to survive 1,600 charging cycles with

80 percent battery health, as per OnePlus' claims. While this is not tested by us, the claim does give users an added assurance of battery longevity.

In our tests, the OnePlus Nord 4 lasted over 15 hours in our standard 4K video loop test on VLC, which is brilliant. The phone lost 7 percent battery (58%-51%) running Google Maps for an hour, and 5 percent battery (42%-37%) when I played Call of Duty: Mobile for 15 minutes. Charging speeds are super fast too with the 100 W SUPERVOOC charging support. The device charged to full from an empty battery in just 29 minutes.

VERDICT

The OnePlus Nord 4 blends modern flair with a touch of nostalgia. Its metallic body brings back memories of metal phones from back in the day but its hardware hasn't been compromised to achieve the same. The phone is powerful enough to play most mobile games with zero lag which makes it a worthy competitor of the POCO F6 and Realme GT 6T, and it also has enough substance to stand out in terms of the display and battery life. There are a few shortcomings though. The phone throttles in benchmarks but I didn't see an adverse effect on day-to-day usage, but the mediocre ultrawide camera and lack of HDR support on a few streaming apps are troublesome. Overall though, I think OnePlus has knocked it out of the park with the OnePlus Nord 4 – the metallic design stands out, the colour variants are gorgeous, and the performance is more than satisfactory.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 7+ Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 732 | RAM: 8/12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 128 GB UFS 3.1 / 256 GB UFS 4.0 | OS: Android 14, OxygenOS 14.1 | Battery: 5,500 mAh | Charging: 100 W SUPERVOOC | Display: 6.74" Super Fluid AMOLED, 2772 x 1240, 120 Hz | Display protection: Panda Glass | Rear cameras: 50 MP + 8 MP | Selfie camera: 16 MP | Weight: 199.5 g | Colours: Obsidian Midnight, Mercurial Silver, Oasis Green

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